

Here's the full curation for **sharp**, anchored to the passage phrase **"a sharp eye for potential."**

SHARP

1. Passage anchor

> "She also had **a sharp eye for potential**."

Passage meaning

sharp = highly perceptive; quick and accurate at noticing or recognizing things

敏銳的；眼光銳利的；善於察覺的

So:

have a sharp eye for something

= be very good at noticing, recognizing, or judging it

對.....有敏銳的眼光；很善於看出.....

In the passage, Mrs. Chan was good at recognizing students' **potential**.

Practice

1. She had **a sharp eye for potential** in quiet students.

她對安靜學生的潛力有**敏銳的眼光**。

2. A good editor needs **a sharp eye for detail**.

優秀的編輯需要對細節有**敏銳的觀察力**。

Core meanings of SHARP

2. sharp — having an edge or point that can cut or pierce

= having a very thin cutting edge or fine point

鋒利的；尖銳的

This is the central physical meaning.

Examples

1. Be careful—the knife is extremely **sharp**.

小心，這把刀非常**鋒利**。

2. The plant has ****sharp thorns****.

這種植物有****尖銳的刺****。

Typical nouns:

* sharp knife 鋒利的刀

* sharp blade 鋒利的刀刃

* sharp needle 尖銳的針

* sharp teeth 尖牙

* sharp claws 利爪

3. sharpen — make or become sharp

****sharpen**** = make an edge or point sharper

****磨利；削尖****

Examples

1. I need to ****sharpen this pencil****.

我需要把這支鉛筆****削尖****。

2. He ****sharpened the knife**** before cooking.

他煮飯前把刀****磨利了****。

This is the most direct derivative of the physical sense.

4. sharp — forming a narrow or pointed shape

= having an angular, pointed, or clearly defined form

****尖的；尖角的；輪廓分明的****

This does not necessarily mean capable of cutting.

Examples

1. The mountain has a ****sharp peak****.

那座山有一個****尖尖的山峰****。

2. The building is known for its ****sharp angles****.

那棟建築以其****銳利的角度線條****聞名。

5. sharp — a sudden or tight change of direction

= changing direction suddenly or at a small angle

****急轉的；陡轉的****

Examples

1. There is a ****sharp bend**** in the road ahead.

前面的道路有一個****急彎****。

2. The driver made a ****sharp turn**** to the left.

司機突然****急轉左邊****。

Common:

* sharp turn 急轉彎

* sharp bend 急彎

* sharp corner 急彎 / 銳角彎道

6. sharply — suddenly changing direction

Examples

1. The road turns ****sharply**** to the right.

這條路突然****急轉向右****。

2. She turned ****sharply**** and walked away.

她****猛然轉身****離開。

Depending on context, ****sharply**** can describe either physical direction or sudden manner.

Sensation and pain

7. sharp pain

= sudden, intense, and clearly localized pain

****尖銳的疼痛；劇痛；刺痛****

Examples

1. I felt a ****sharp pain**** in my shoulder.

我的肩膀突然感到一陣**劇烈刺痛**。

2. He experienced a **sharp pain** when he stood up.

他站起來時感到一陣**尖銳的疼痛**。

Contrast

* **sharp pain** = sudden, piercing pain

* **dull pain / dull ache** = less intense, heavy or persistent pain

8. sharp — strongly affecting the senses

= intense, penetrating, or strongly noticeable to a sense

強烈的；刺鼻的；刺耳的；刺人的

The exact Chinese depends on the sense involved.

Examples

1. There was a **sharp smell** of vinegar in the room.

房間裡有一股**刺鼻的醋味**。

2. A **sharp sound** came from behind us.

我們身後傳來一聲**尖銳刺耳的聲音**。

Possible contexts:

* sharp smell 刺鼻的氣味

* sharp taste 強烈 / 辛辣 / 酸澀的味道

* sharp sound 尖銳的聲音

* sharp light 刺眼的光

These uses share the idea of a sensation that “cuts” strongly into perception.

9. sharp — strong, acidic, bitter, or pungent in flavour

= having a strong taste that produces a biting sensation

味道強烈的；酸澀的；辛辣刺激的

Examples

1. The cheese has a pleasantly **sharp flavour**.

這種起司有一種令人愉悅的**濃烈味道**。

2. The sauce had a slightly **sharp taste**.

這種醬汁帶有些許**刺激性的味道**。

The exact translation depends heavily on the food.

Mental ability and perception

10. sharp — mentally quick and intelligent

= quick to understand, notice, or think

頭腦敏銳的；機靈的；聰明的

Examples

1. She is still mentally **sharp** in her eighties.

她八十多歲了，頭腦依然十分**敏銳**。

2. You need to stay **sharp** during the interview.

面試時你必須保持**頭腦敏捷**。

This is one of the most important figurative extensions.

11. a sharp mind / sharp intellect

= an intelligent mind that understands things quickly and accurately

敏銳的頭腦；敏捷的思維

Examples

1. He has a remarkably **sharp mind**.

他有非常**敏銳的頭腦**。

2. Her **sharp intellect** impressed everyone in the discussion.

她**敏捷而精明的思維**給討論中的每個人留下深刻印象。

12. sharp — perceptive; good at noticing details

= highly observant or perceptive

****觀察敏銳的；有洞察力的****

This is the passage family.

Examples

1. A detective needs ****sharp powers of observation****.
偵探需要****敏銳的觀察力****。
2. His ****sharp observation**** helped him notice the inconsistency.
他****敏銳的觀察力****使他注意到那個矛盾之處。

13. have a sharp eye for something

= be particularly good at noticing, selecting, or judging something

****對.....眼光敏銳；善於識別.....****

Examples

1. She has ****a sharp eye for talent****.
她對人才有****敏銳的眼光****。
2. He has ****a sharp eye for small errors****.
他很善於****發現細微的錯誤****。

Passage

****a sharp eye for potential****

= ****善於看出他人的潛力****

This is not about eyesight quality. It concerns ****perception and judgment****.

14. sharp eyesight / hearing / senses

= highly sensitive and capable of detecting small details

****敏銳的視力 / 聽力 / 感官****

Examples

1. Eagles have extremely ****sharp eyesight****.
老鷹擁有極為****敏銳的視力****。

2. His hearing remained ****sharp**** despite his age.

儘管年紀大了，他的聽力仍然很****敏銳****。

This is sensory ability rather than intellectual insight.

15. keep / stay sharp

= remain mentally alert, capable, and quick

****保持敏銳；保持警覺；保持最佳狀態****

Examples

1. Regular reading helps me ****stay sharp****.

經常閱讀有助於我****保持頭腦敏銳****。

2. You need to ****keep sharp**** during a long match.

長時間比賽期間，你需要****保持警覺和專注****。

Communication and behaviour

16. sharp — severe, critical, or harsh in speech

= spoken in an angry, severe, or strongly critical manner

****嚴厲的；尖刻的；不客氣的****

Examples

1. She gave him a ****sharp reply****.

她給了他一個****尖銳而不客氣的回答****。

2. His manager issued a ****sharp warning****.

他的經理給了他一次****嚴厲的警告****。

17. sharp words / sharp tongue

****sharp words**** = harsh or cutting remarks

****尖刻的話；刺人的話****

****a sharp tongue**** = tendency to speak critically or hurtfully

****說話尖刻；嘴巴厲害****

Examples

1. They exchanged a few **sharp words**.
他們互相說了幾句**尖銳難聽的話**。
2. She is kind-hearted despite having **a sharp tongue**.
她雖然**說話尖刻**，其實心地善良。

This metaphor again comes from the physical idea of something that “cuts.”

18. sharply — angrily, sternly, or critically

Examples

1. “Stop that,” she said **sharply**.
「住手，」她**嚴厲地**說。
2. He spoke **sharply** to the waiter.
他用**很不客氣的語氣**對服務生說話。

Change, difference, and contrast

19. sharp increase / rise

= large and sudden

急劇的；大幅而突然的

Examples

1. There was a **sharp increase** in prices.
價格出現**急劇上升**。
2. The city recorded a **sharp rise** in demand.
這座城市的需求**大幅攀升**。

20. sharp fall / drop / decline

= large and sudden downward change

急劇下降的；大幅下跌的

Examples

1. The company suffered a **sharp fall** in sales.
公司的銷售額出現**大幅下降**。
2. Temperatures will show a **sharp drop** tonight.
今晚氣溫將會**急劇下降**。

21. sharply — by a large amount and suddenly

= rapidly and substantially

急劇地；大幅地

Examples

1. Costs have risen **sharply** this year.
今年成本**大幅上升**。
2. Demand fell **sharply** after the holiday.
假期後需求**急劇下降**。

This is especially common in:

- * economics
- * statistics
- * news
- * academic writing

22. sharp contrast

= a very clear and striking difference

鮮明的對比；強烈反差

Examples

1. Her calm personality was in **sharp contrast** to his.
她沉著的個性與他的性格形成**鮮明對比**。
2. There is a **sharp contrast** between the two approaches.
這兩種方法之間存在**明顯而強烈的差異**。

23. sharply different / sharply divided

= clearly or strongly different / divided

****截然不同的；嚴重分歧的****

Examples

1. Their opinions are ****sharply different****.
他們的看法****截然不同****。
2. The committee was ****sharply divided**** on the issue.
委員會在這個問題上****意見嚴重分歧****。

Precision and definition

24. sharp — clear and clearly defined

= having distinct lines, boundaries, or visual details

****清晰的；輪廓分明的；鮮明的****

Examples

1. The photograph is extremely ****sharp****.
這張照片非常****清晰****。
2. The mountains stood out in ****sharp detail****.
山脈以****清晰鮮明的細節****呈現出來。

25. sharp image / focus

= visually clear and well focused

****清晰的；對焦準確的****

Examples

1. This lens produces very ****sharp images****.
這個鏡頭能拍出非常****清晰的影像****。
2. The subject is not completely ****sharp**** in this photograph.
這張照片中的主體並沒有完全****對焦清晰****。

This is particularly common in photography and optics.

26. sharpen an image / distinction / argument

The physical “make sharper” meaning extends metaphorically to:

= make clearer, stronger, or more precise

****使更清晰；使更明確；強化****

Examples

1. The new evidence ****sharpened the distinction**** between the two theories.

新證據使兩種理論之間的區別****更加明確****。

2. Editing helped ****sharpen her argument****.

編輯使她的論點變得****更有力、更明確****。

Time and punctuality

27. at six sharp

= exactly at the stated time

****整；準時；正好****

Examples

1. The meeting begins at nine ****sharp****.

會議****九點整****開始。

2. Be here at seven ****sharp****.

請****七點整準時****到這裡。

This use normally follows a clock time:

****8:00 sharp****

= ****八點整****

Clothing and appearance

28. sharp — smart, stylish, and well dressed

= fashionable and neat in appearance

****俐落有型的；穿著體面的；帥氣的****

Examples

1. You look ****sharp**** in that suit.
你穿那套西裝看起來很****俐落有型****。
2. He arrived looking extremely ****sharp****.
他到場時看起來非常****體面有型****。

This is especially common in informal English.

29. sharp dresser

= someone who dresses stylishly and neatly

****很會穿衣服的人；衣著有型的人****

Examples

1. He has always been a ****sharp dresser****.
他一向都****很會穿衣服****。
2. Her grandfather was known as a ****sharp dresser****.
她祖父以****衣著講究有型****聞名。

Music

30. sharp — slightly higher than the correct musical pitch

= above the intended pitch

****偏高的；升高的****

Examples

1. That note sounds slightly ****sharp****.
那個音聽起來有一點****偏高****。
2. The singer was ****sharp**** on the final note.
歌手唱最後一個音時****音高偏高****。

Opposite

****flat**** = below the correct pitch

****音偏低****

31. sharp — the musical symbol # / a raised note

In music, ****sharp**** can also be a noun.

****a sharp**** = a symbol or note indicating one semitone higher

****升記號；升音****

Examples

1. Put a ****sharp**** before the F.

在 F 前加一個****升記號****。

2. This piece contains several ****sharps****.

這首曲子中有好幾個****升記號****。

Examples of note names:

* F-sharp = F# = 升F

* C-sharp = C# = 升C

Weather

32. sharp — very cold in a fresh, biting way

= noticeably and unpleasantly cold

****刺骨的；凜冽的****

Examples

1. A ****sharp wind**** blew across the field.

一陣****凜冽的寒風****吹過田野。

2. There was a ****sharp chill**** in the morning air.

清晨的空氣中帶著一股****刺骨的寒意****。

Again, the metaphor is something that seems to “cut” into the body.

Movement and reaction

33. sharp — sudden and forceful

= abrupt, quick, and often strong

****突然的；猛烈的****

Examples

1. She took a ****sharp breath****.
她突然****猛吸了一口氣****。
2. He gave the rope a ****sharp pull****.
他****猛地拉了一下****繩子。

Common:

- * sharp movement 突然的動作
- * sharp jerk 猛然一動
- * sharp intake of breath 猛吸一口氣

Business / informal usage

34. sharp practice

= clever but dishonest or unfair business behaviour

****不正當手段；狡猾而不公平的做法****

Examples

1. The company was accused of ****sharp practice****.
那家公司被指控採取****不正當的商業手段****。
2. Regulators introduced rules to prevent ****sharp practices****.
監管機構推出規則以防止****欺詐或不公平做法****。

This is established, especially in British English, but lower priority for general learners.

Noun: a sharp person

35. sharp — a dishonest cheat or swindler

Historically, **sharp** could function as a noun for a dishonest or cunning person.

This survives mainly in older expressions and is **not a priority modern learner sense**.

For modern learning purposes, it is better recognized than actively used.

Useful derivatives

36. sharpen

A. make a cutting edge sharper

磨利；削尖

She **sharpened the scissors**.

她把剪刀**磨利**。

B. improve a skill or ability

提升；磨練

The course helped me **sharpen my writing skills**.

這門課幫助我**磨練寫作技巧**。

C. make a distinction, idea, image, etc. clearer

使更清晰；使更鮮明

The discussion **sharpened our understanding** of the problem.

這場討論使我們對問題的理解**更加清楚**。

37. sharpener

= a tool used to sharpen something

削鉛筆器；磨刀器；磨具

Examples

1. Can I borrow your pencil **sharpener**?

我可以借你的**削鉛筆器**嗎？

2. He used a knife **sharpener** before preparing dinner.
他準備晚餐前使用了**磨刀器**。

38. sharpness

A. physical cutting quality

鋒利度

The **sharpness** of the blade makes it dangerous.
刀刃的**鋒利程度**使它很危險。

B. mental/perceptual ability

敏銳度；敏捷程度

Age had not reduced her mental **sharpness**.
年齡並沒有降低她思維的**敏銳度**。

C. image clarity

清晰度；銳利度

You can adjust the image **sharpness**.
你可以調整影像的**銳利度**。

39. sharply

Major meanings include:

- * turn **sharply** = 急轉
- * speak **sharply** = 嚴厲地說
- * rise **sharply** = 急劇上升
- * contrast **sharply** = 形成鮮明對比
- * be **sharply** critical = 強烈批評

The correct Chinese translation depends on which **sharp** meaning the adverb inherits.

High-value fixed combinations

40. sharp eye

= strong ability to notice or judge

****敏銳的眼光；敏銳的觀察力****

She has ****a sharp eye for design****.

她對設計有****敏銳的眼光****。

41. sharp ears

= excellent hearing or ability to notice sounds

****敏銳的聽力****

You have ****sharp ears**** if you noticed that.

你竟然聽出來了，聽力真****敏銳****。

42. sharp memory

= an excellent ability to remember things clearly

****敏銳 / 清晰的記憶力****

Even at ninety, he had a ****sharp memory****.

即使九十歲，他仍有****很好的記憶力****。

43. sharp wit

= quick, clever humour or intelligence

****機智；敏捷的才思****

Examples

1. She is famous for her ****sharp wit****.

她以****敏捷的機智****聞名。

2. His ****sharp wit**** made him an entertaining speaker.

他的****機智反應****使他成為很有趣的演講者。

Depending on context, ****sharp wit**** can be amusing or somewhat cutting.

44. sharp criticism

= strong, severe criticism

****嚴厲批評；尖銳批評****

Examples

1. The proposal received ****sharp criticism****.
該提案受到****嚴厲批評****。
2. Her comments drew ****sharp criticism**** from colleagues.
她的言論引來同事的****強烈批評****。

45. sharp distinction / division

= very clear difference or boundary

****明確的區別；鮮明的界線****

Examples

1. The theory makes a ****sharp distinction**** between the two concepts.
這套理論對兩個概念作出****明確區分****。
2. There is no ****sharp division**** between the two categories.
這兩個類別之間並沒有****清楚明確的界線****。

This is especially useful in academic English.

Meaning map

The semantic family of ****sharp**** is built around the physical idea:

****a fine edge or point that cuts strongly****

From this develop several metaphorical branches:

****physical edge****

→ sharp knife

→ ****鋒利的****

****pointed form****

→ sharp peak / sharp angle

→ ****尖的；銳角的****

****cutting physical sensation****

→ sharp pain / sharp smell / sharp wind

→ ****刺痛的；刺鼻的；刺骨的****

****cutting perception****

→ sharp eyesight / sharp eye / sharp mind

→ ****敏銳的****

****cutting speech****

→ sharp reply / sharp criticism

→ ****尖銳的；嚴厲的****

****abrupt shape or movement****

→ sharp turn

→ ****急轉的****

****abrupt numerical change****

→ sharp rise / sharp fall

→ ****急劇的****

****clearly defined edges****

→ sharp image / sharp distinction

→ ****清晰的；鮮明的****

This semantic network is why one English word can correspond to many different Chinese translations while still retaining a coherent central metaphor.

Essential contrasts

sharp vs pointed

****sharp****

= capable of cutting/piercing OR very fine at the end

****pointed****

= having a pointed shape

A knife can be ****sharp**** without being strongly pointed.

A decorative object can be ****pointed**** without being sharp enough to cut.

sharp vs clever

****sharp**** emphasizes:

- * quick understanding
- * alertness
- * perception

****clever**** more generally means:

- * intelligent
- * skilful at thinking or solving problems

> She is ****sharp****.

often suggests ****反應快、頭腦敏銳**** rather than merely ****聰明****.

sharp vs observant

****observant****

= habitually good at noticing things

****善於觀察的****

****sharp****

= especially quick and accurate in perception

****敏銳的****

So:

****a sharp eye for potential****

contains not only “noticing,” but also ****accurate judgment****.

sharp vs severe

In expressions such as:

- * sharp criticism
- * sharp rebuke

* sharp reply

****sharp**** can mean strong, cutting, or harsh.

****severe**** is broader and often more formal:

* severe punishment

* severe illness

* severe criticism

Passage recap

> “She also had ****a sharp eye for potential****.”

Here, ****sharp**** does NOT mean:

* 鋒利的

* 尖的

* 急劇的

* 尖銳刺耳的

It means:

****highly perceptive and accurate in noticing something****

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* ****眼光敏銳****

* ****有敏銳的觀察力****

* ****很善於看出別人的潛力****

MCQ-ready meaning

****sharp**** in ****“a sharp eye for potential”****

= ****perceptive / observant / quick to recognize****

****敏銳的；善於察覺的****

The key conceptual bridge is:

****sharp blade cuts precisely****

→ ****sharp perception detects precisely****.